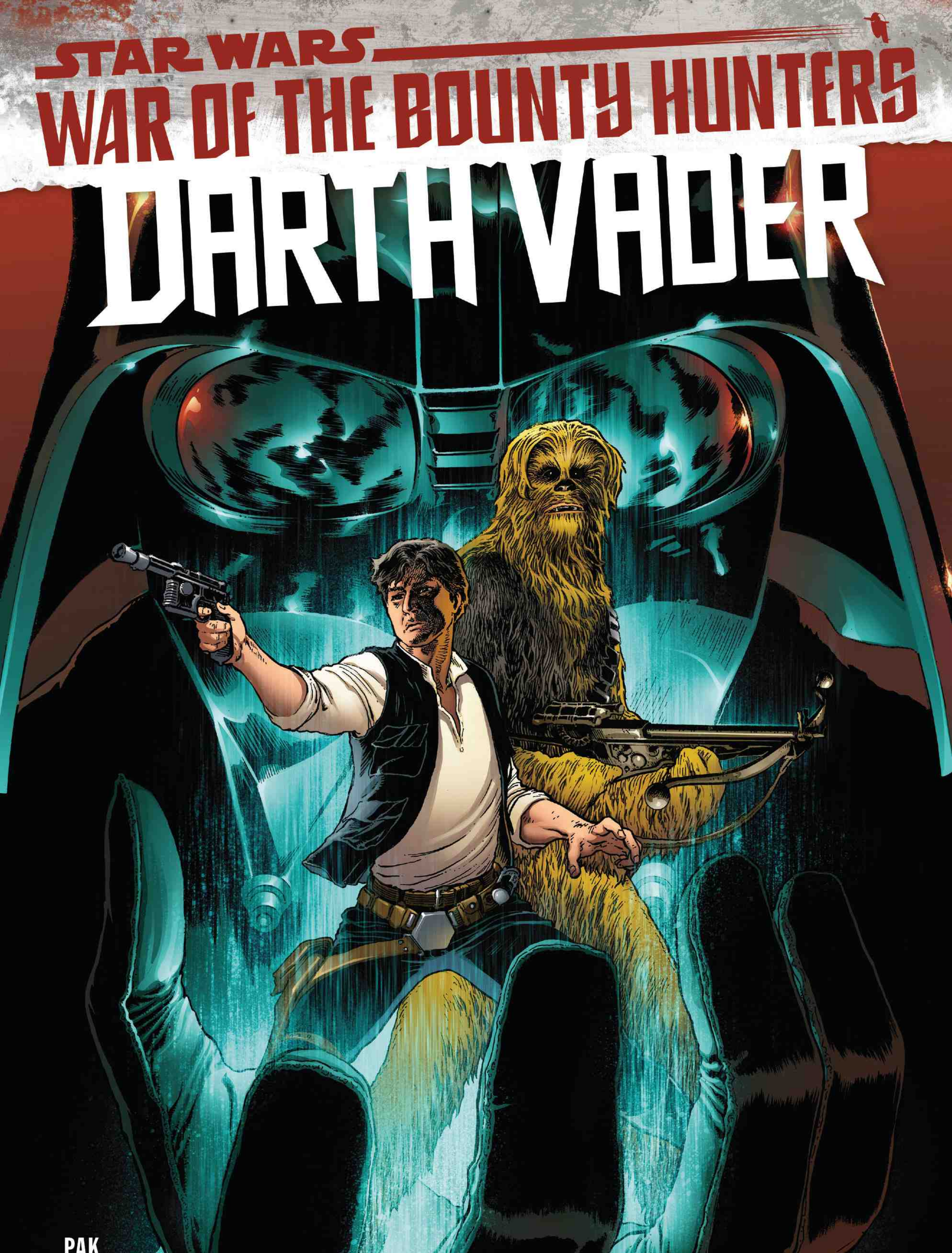
STAR WARS

WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS

DARTH VADER



PAK
VILANOVA
WHITE

MARVEL
12

PRELUDE

"INTO THE TRAP"

WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS

PRELUDE: Into the Trap

Emperor Palpatine finally revealed to Darth Vader a mere glimpse of his power on Exegol.

It was enough to make Vader kneel before his master once more.

Darth Vader is beginning to understand the full scope and might of the Emperor's plans for the galaxy. Now Vader's own plans must also change....

GREG PAK
Writer

GUIU VILANOVA
Artist

DEAN WHITE with GIADA MARCHISIO
Colorist

VC's JOE CARAMAGNA
Letterer

AARON KUDER & RICHARD ISANOVE
Cover Artists

CHRIS SPROUSE, KARL STORY & NEERAJ MENON; AARON KUDER & RICHARD ISANOVE
Variant Cover Artists

TOM GRONEMAN
Assistant Editor

MARK PANICCIA
Editor

C.B. CEBULSKI
Editor in Chief

For Lucasfilm:
Senior Editor ROBERT SIMPSON
Creative Director MICHAEL SIGLAIN
Art Director TROY ALDERS
Lucasfilm Story Group PABLO HIDALGO, MATT MARTIN & EMILY SHKOUKANI
Lucasfilm Art Department PHIL SZOSTAK



Coruscant.

MAKE WAY FOR THE RETURN OF *LORD VADER!*

OR WHAT'S *LEFT* OF HIM.

HOW IS HE EVEN *ALIVE*, ADMINISTRATOR?

HE IS A *SITH*, MAS AMEDDA.

HIS *HATRED* GIVES HIM *POWER*.

YOUR WILL, MY LORD?

RESTORE HIM. COMPLETELY.

YOUR EMINENCE... HE WANTED TO *KILL* YOU.

IF THAT *HATE* STILL *DRIVES* HIM...

ALMOST *EVERYONE* I HAVE EVER *MET* HAS WANTED TO KILL ME, *GRAND VIZIER.*

BUT I SHOWED MY AMBITIOUS APPRENTICE THE *MIGHT* OF *EXEGOL.*

HE KNOWS THE *LIMITS* OF HIS *ROLE* NOW.

NNNNHH!

TTZZZTT

ONCE I HAVE *FIXED* HIM...

...HE WILL FIND A MORE APPROPRIATE TARGET FOR HIS *HATE.*

HA HA!

SO *CONCERNED!*

DO NOT WORRY YOURSELVES.

I AM BEYOND HIS REACH. AND *YOU* ARE BENEATH HIS NOTICE.

HE WILL FIND HIS *TRUE ENEMY* SOON ENOUGH.

NO.

PREPARE FOR SHUTDOWN.

AS YOU WISH.

VZZZZZZZZZZ

SKRRRAAAAK

GRRRAAAAA!

Pain.

ZZZZZZNNNNGGG

GRRRAAAA!

VNNNNNN

AAAAGH!

Like I gave to YOU, my son.

SKRRRAAAAAK

HA HA!

Did it lead you to *hate*?

Did it lead you to *power*?

VZZZZTTTTT

GRRRAAAAA!

TZZT

HA!

No.

You could have *ruled the galaxy* by my side.

The Battle of Yavin.

I'M ON THE LEADER.

THE *FORCE* IS STRONG WITH THIS ONE.

But despite all your *promise...*

...you're *weak.*

FRAKOOOM

WHAT?!

You have never done *anything...*

...without your *friends.*

FWOOOOSH

YEEEE-HOOO!

LOOK OUT!

SKLAAANK

BRAKOOM

FRAAAKKK

Corellia.
Some time later.

ALL RIGHT, SHE'S ALL FIXED UP!

LET'S GET OUT OF HERE BEFORE--

ZZZ

SKRAKOW SKRAAKOW

AAAROOO?

YEAH, IT'S COMING FROM THE OTHER YT ACROSS THE--

OH NO.

YOU...

VADER...

VNNNNNN

AROOOOOO!

I KNOW, CHEWIE!

THAT'S WHY WE'RE RUNNING!

VOOOOOOOM

SKRAAKOOW SKRAKOWW

RRRAOOWR?

YES, I SAW HIM DEFLECT OUR LASER CANNONS!

ARRROOOOO!

YES, I *KNOW* THE HYPERDRIVE'S STILL BUSTED!

ARROUGH?

NO, I DON'T THINK WE CAN *TAKE* HIM!

WE'VE BEEN IN OVER OUR HEADS EVER SINCE *LUKE* BLEW UP THE DEATH STAR, CHEWIE.

LET'S FACE IT-- WE'RE A COUPLA NOBODIES HERE...

...BUT FOR *ONCE*...

"...MAYBE THAT'LL WORK TO OUR *ADVANTAGE.*"

Corellian Engineering Corporation YT-Series Warranty and Repair Shipyard B33.

Later.

I'M TERRIBLY SORRY YOU WERE UNABLE TO FIND YOUR PARTY.

BUT I DON'T MIND TELLING YOU IT'S AN **ENORMOUS** HONOR...

...I CAN'T IMAGINE **ANY** YT-SERIES SHIPYARD HAS **EVER** HAD A VISITOR OF SUCH **MAGNITUDE**--

SILENCE.

THERE.

RIGHT! THAT'S **HAN SOLO.**

SOLO?

YEAH, **LOCAL BOY,** ACTUALLY. BUT YOU CAN'T SAY HE **MADE GOOD.**

JUST ANOTHER **SCRUMRAT** TURNED **SMUGGLER.**

HE CAN'T HAVE GOTTEN FAR. SHOULD WE--?

NO.

NO? IT REALLY WOULDN'T BE ANY TROUBLE.

IF LORD VADER SAYS *NO*--

VNNNNNNN

--THE ANSWER IS NO!

Your friends.

You think they saved you.

You think you saved them.

THERE WILL BE A SUBSTANTIAL *REWARD* FOR THE ONE WHO *FINDS* THE *MILLENNIUM FALCON*.

"YOU ARE FREE TO USE *ANY* METHODS *NECESSARY*...

AAAAAAAAGH!

"...BUT I WANT THEM *ALIVE*."

THEY DIDN'T EVEN ASK ME ANY QUESTIONS.

Good...

...keep on *believing* it...

...believe that you and your friends have survived this long through *strength* or *fortune*...

AOOORRR!

STOP, CHEWIE! STOP!

HN!

...instead of *my design.*

FFFFFFSSSST

CLAAANG

SKLAAANG

HNNN?

WHAT IS YOUR WILL, MY MASTER?

WHAT IS *YOUR* WILL, MY APPRENTICE?

YOU'VE SEEN THE *SECRETS* OF THE *DARK SIDE.*

YOU KNOW THE WAY OF THE *SITH.*

DECIDE FOR *YOURSELF.*

AH!

HA HA HA HA!

OCHI OF BESTOON.

M-ME?

MY LORD?

GO ON, ASSASSIN.

EVERYONE HAS THEIR ROLE TO PLAY.

WHERE... WHERE ARE WE GOING?

LORD VADER?

You could still be *strong*, my son.

I know there is *power* in you.

But I have seen the true *might* and *purpose* of the *Sith*.

And there is no room for *another*.

So this time...

...you will die.

Outer Rim.

<YOU WANT SOLO?>*

*TRANSLATED FROM HUTTESE.

<SOLO WAS STOLEN.>

YOU MEAN JABBA LOST HIM.

<JABBA REMAINS STRONG. HE WILL RECOVER HIM, AND HIS POWER WILL INCREASE.>

NO, BOKKU...

...YOU WILL RECOVER HIM, AND GIVE HIM TO ME.

AND, LUCKY YOU, YOUR POWER WILL INCREASE.

<SO... STRANGE, OCHI OF BESTOON.>

<NONE OF MY REGULAR IMPERIAL CONTACTS HAVE SPOKEN TO ME OF THIS...FOOLHARDY PLAN.>

<ARE YOU CERTAIN THAT YOU SERVE THE EMPEROR?>

I SERVE POWER, BOKKU. SO TODAY...

...I SERVE VADER.

AS DO YOU.

To be continued in STAR WARS WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS #1!

STAR WARS WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS

DARTH VADER

From the beginning, STAR WARS: DARTH VADER has felt like one of those special books. It's been blessed with tremendous art teams, incredible editors, wildly supportive readers and amazing partners at Lucasfilm, who gave us the green light to explore this eerie time in Vader's story in such emotional depth and to add so much to classic characters from every era in the *STAR WARS* mythos.

So I'm thrilled to report that as we head into the biggest STAR WARS comics crossover in the modern Marvel era with WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS, we'll keep raising the stakes of Vader's emotional journey: his anger at the Emperor, his growing understanding of the threat of Luke Skywalker and his own relationship with ambition and power. At the same time, we'll dig deep into the hearts and minds of unexpected characters in Vader's ambit--from the original trilogy's IG-88, to the prequels' Umbaran administrator, Sly Moore, to the final trilogy's Ochi of Bestoon. These are stories you won't find anywhere else, and it blows my mind every day that we're getting to tell them.

Huge thanks to the entire creative team and to everyone who's been reading and supporting these books. We've got so much more coming your way. See you next month as Vader takes on everyone's favorite old school Phlutdroid--and reveals more about the nature of his own dark heart.

Greg Pak
New York City

STAR WARS
WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS

MAY

WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS PRELUDES

WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS ALPHA

By Charles Soule and Steve McNiven. "Precious Cargo"
Boba Fett travels to Nar Shaddaa to fix Han Solo's malfunctioning carbonite. The only way to pay for the job? Gladiatorial combat.

STAR WARS #13

By Charles Soule and Ramon Rosanas. "The Hunt for Han Solo"
Luke Skywalker and Chewbacca head to Nar Shaddaa to hunt down Boba Fett and his prize!

BOUNTY HUNTERS #12

By Ethan Sacks and Paolo Villanelli. "Target Solo"
Valance and Dengar tear through Nar Shaddaa for leads on Han Solo's location, but Valance can't escape his past or a deadly assassin!

DARTH VADER #12

By Greg Pak and Guiu Vilanova. "Into the Trap"
Darth Vader's body and status are restored! But his thoughts drift to the past…when he first hunted Han Solo after the smuggler defied him at the Death Star!

DOCTOR APHRA #10
5/26/2021
By Alyssa Wong and Ray-Anthony Height. "The Invitation"
Doctor Aphra and Sana Starros attempt a daring escape from Vukorah and the Unbroken Clan, setting them on a collision course with one of the galaxy's most frightening bounty hunters!

JUNE

WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS #1

STAR WARS #14

DARTH VADER #13

DOCTOR APHRA #11

BOUNTY HUNTERS #13

JULY

WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS #2

STAR WARS #15

DARTH VADER #14

DOCTOR APHRA #12

BOUNTY HUNTERS #14

JABBA THE HUTT #1

AUGUST

WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS #3

STAR WARS #16

DARTH VADER #15

DOCTOR APHRA #13

BOUNTY HUNTERS #15

4-LOM & ZUCKUSS #1

SEPTEMBER

WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS #4

STAR WARS #17

DARTH VADER #16

DOCTOR APHRA #14

BOUNTY HUNTERS #16

BOUSHH #1

OCTOBER

WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS #5

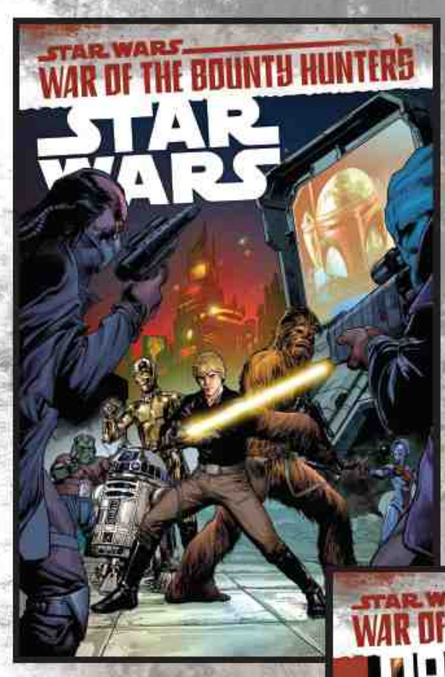
STAR WARS #18

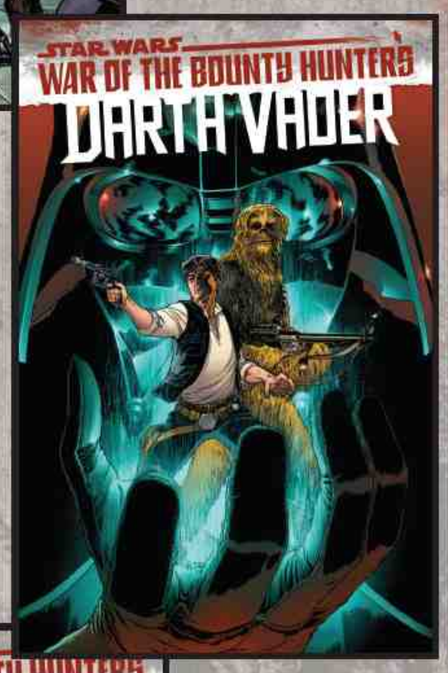
DARTH VADER #17

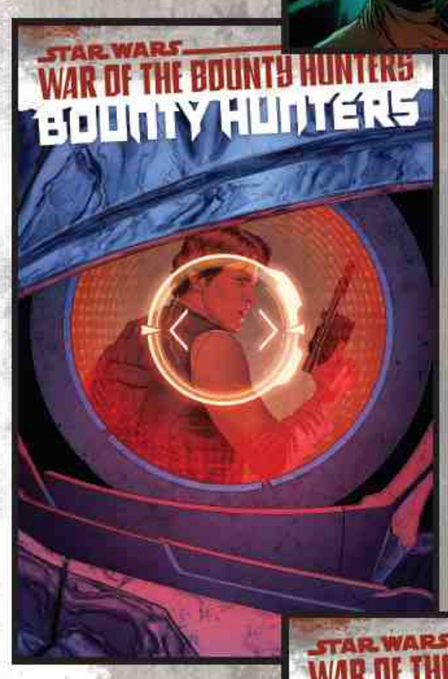
DOCTOR APHRA #15

BOUNTY HUNTERS #17

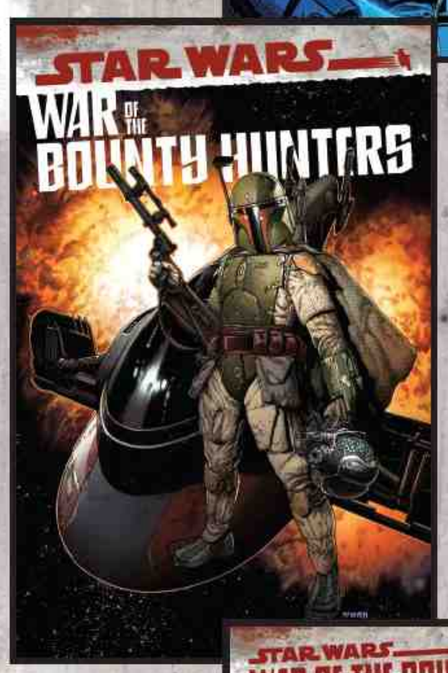
IG-88 #1

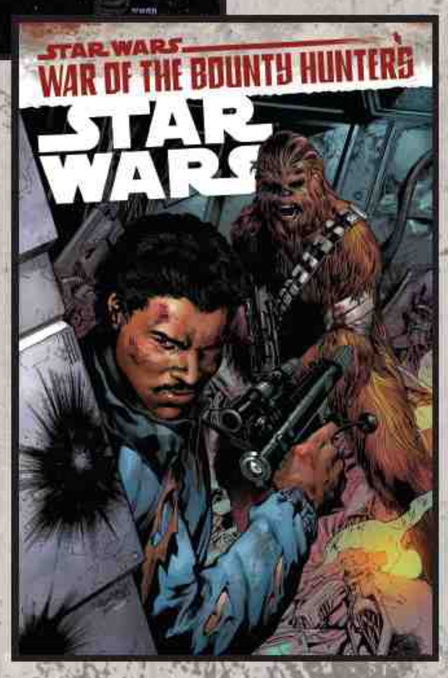












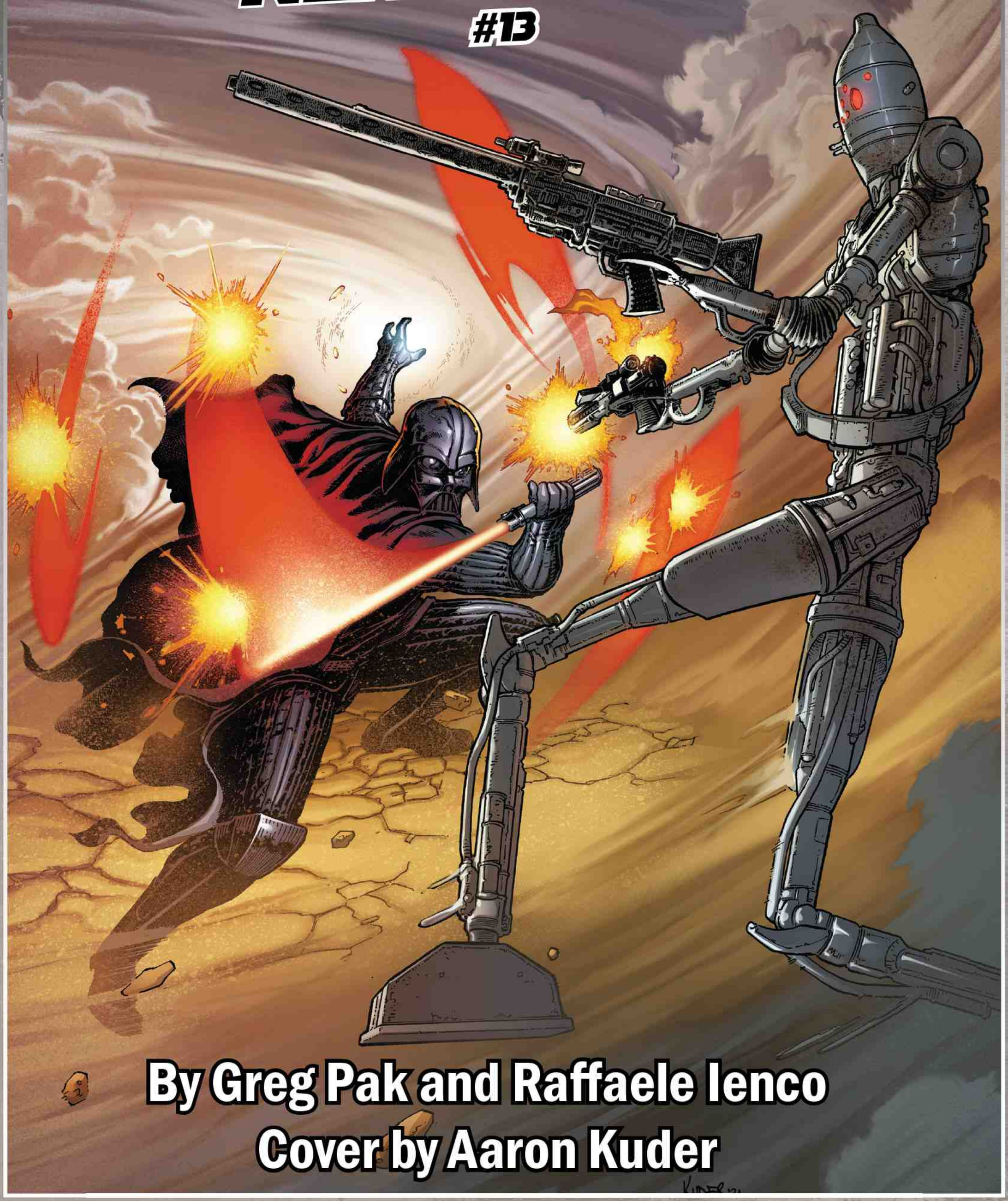
STAR WARS

WAR OF THE BOUNTY HUNTERS

DARTH VADER

NEXT ISSUE:

#13



By Greg Pak and Raffaele Ienco

Cover by Aaron Kuder

STAR WARS and related text and illustrations are trademarks and/or copyrights, in the United States and other countries, of Lucasfilm Ltd. and/or its affiliates. © & TM Lucasfilm Ltd. No similarity between any of the names, characters, persons, and/or institutions in this magazine with those of any living or dead person or institution is intended, and any such similarity which may exist is purely coincidental. Marvel and its logos are TM Marvel Characters, Inc. WWW.MARVEL.COM

@marvelcomicpdf

MY NAME IS JEAN GREY.

NOW...